

“Brian & Co. Parliament Square SW1” Press Release

13th July 2009

Brian & Co. Parliament Square SW1 is a new documentary film by Japanese film-maker Yumiko Hayakawa. The film is about the British peace campaigner, Brian Haw, and his supporters. Brian Haw began a peace campaign in Parliament Square, London in June 2001 and has remained there 24 hours a day ever since. Filmed over the course of one and a half years, Brian & Co. captures this unique peace campaign through interviews with Brian and his supporters. The film also sheds light on how freedom of speech is threatened in the UK and people's imaginative and unrelenting ways of defending their rights.



Awards

Japan Congress of Journalists (JCJ) - New Face Award 2009

Festival Screenings

July 2009

3rd Awa Peace Film Festival (Chiba, Japan)

23rd Fukuoka Asian Film Festival (Fukuoka, Japan)

August 2009

Toyonaka Peace Film Festival 2009 (Osaka, Japan)

September 2009

Aichi International Women's Film Festival 2009 (Aichi, Japan)

14th Nagaoka Asian Film Festival (Niigata, Japan)

14th Kuso-no-Mori Film Festival (Hokkaido, Japan)

Synopsis

Brian & Co. Parliament Square SW1 is a brand new documentary film about the British peace campaigner, Brian Haw, and his supporters. Brian Haw began his demonstration in Parliament Square, London on 2nd June 2001 and remained in the square ever since. He is campaigning against the US/UK governments' policy of "war on terror" as well as protesting on behalf of the innocent victims of war and greed.

Since he started his campaign in the square, he has become a living symbol of the British anti-war movement. People from around the world of every age and faith support him, some of them have even been living in Parliament Square since 2006. In 2005, the UK government passed a law (the Serious Organised Crime and Police Act 2005) which included legislation specifically aimed at removing Haw from Parliament Square. 78 police removed almost all of his display and applied conditions on his demonstration. Despite this, Brian and his supporters are still campaigning in the square to this date.

Through a year and a half of filming, the documentary captures this unique peace campaign from different aspects through interviews with Brian and his colourful supporters – from single mothers who decided to give up normal lives to live in the square as full-time peace campaigners, an anti-war activist who has been rebelling for over 60 years, an eccentric puppet artist, former Labour MP Tony Benn to UK/Japanese peace campaigners. The film also sheds light on how freedom of speech is threatened in the UK and people's imaginative and unrelenting ways of defending their rights.

Main Characters (in order of appearance)

Brian Haw - Barbara Tucker - Maria Gallastegui - C.N. Easton (a.k.a. Bunny) - Carolyn Emmerson - Aya Shiino



Biography of the director

Yumiko Hayakawa was born in Tokyo, Japan in 1975. Graduated from Seikei University in Japan, and the London School of Journalism in the UK. During her study in London, she met Brian Haw and was introduced to his peace campaign. She started filming in May 2007. Brian & Co. Parliament Square SW1 is her first ever documentary film!

Technical credits

Director: Yumiko Hayakawa
Filming: Yumiko Hayakawa, Paul Wright, Brian Haw
Still photos: rikki (Indymedia.org.uk), Terence Bunch, Barbara Tucker, Paul Wright, Milan Hajsinek, Silvie Koanda, Yumiko Hayakawa
Narration: Yumiko Hayakawa, Maria Gallastegui
Editing: Yumiko Hayakawa, Paul Wright
Music: YANEKA, Paul Wright, Hiroshima University Affiliated Junior High and High School Orchestral Club
Japanese subtitles: Hinako Yoshida, Rie Hiramatsu, Michiyo Watanabe
English subtitles: Paul Wright, Yumiko Hayakawa

Technical information

Production countries: UK, Japan
Production Year: February 2009
Screening Format: DVD
Colour,
Wide screen 16:9,
Stereo sound
Running Time: 97 minutes
Note: Digital Video available on request



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